PassFrame
TUITION

The Grumbly Gnome

Year 4 — 11+ Homework Worksheet (PassFrame Tuition)

Comprehension | Poetry

Extract (poem) — read it carefully before answering

In a hollow by the bramble tree
there lived a gnome quite grey and grim,
who grumbled at the buzzing bee
and grumbled at the blackbird's hymn.

He grumbled when the sun came up,
he grumbled when the rain came down,
he grumbled at his chipped old cup,
he grumbled at his pointy crown.

But one wet Tuesday, cold and bleak,
a baby mouse got stuck in mud.
The gnome went out (he had to peek)
and pulled her free with a gentle tug.

The mouse squeaked, 'Thank you!' bright and clear,
and curled up snug beside his boot.
The gnome felt something strange, my dear —
a small warm feeling, soft as soot.

He didn't grumble, not that day,
nor any day from that day on.
The gnome had found, in his own way,
a friend to grumble gently upon.

Questions

25 min · 12 questions

1. What two things does the gnome grumble at in the first verse?

2. What was wrong with the mouse at the start of verse three?

3. Underline the line that shows the mouse thanked the gnome.

4. Underline the rhyming pair of words in the final verse.

5. What does the phrase “snug beside his boot” tell you about where the mouse settled?

6. Put these events in order: the gnome pulls the mouse free / the mouse curls up beside the gnome / the gnome grumbles at his chipped cup / the gnome feels a warm feeling.

7. Why do you think the poet describes the gnome as “quite grey and grim” at the start?

8. What is the last line of the poem, and what do you think it means?

9. How is the gnome at the end of the poem different from the gnome at the beginning?

10. Why might the poet have chosen rhyme for this poem instead of writing it as a normal story?

11. Find and copy a word from the poem that means “squeezed” or “pulled”.

12. Write one or two sentences describing the gnome in your own words, using evidence from the poem.